

Emergency Department Escalation Procedure

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Emergency Department Pressure Triggers

Emergency Department escalation should be considered when demand exceeds the department's available operational capacity.

Indicators may include sustained increases in attendances, deterioration in four-hour performance, crowding, ambulance arrivals exceeding available assessment capacity, and significant delays in patient flow.

The operational site team should review pressure indicators collectively rather than relying on a single measure.

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Escalation Actions and Oversight

When Emergency Department pressure becomes severe, operational leadership should coordinate actions across emergency care, bed management, diagnostics, discharge services and workforce teams.

Actions should be documented, reviewed at agreed intervals, and adjusted when operational conditions change.

Decisions remain subject to local governance arrangements and human operational accountability.